I have great pleasure in welcoming…/ It is my pleasure to welcome…	It was felt that…	This meeting/conference stands for
I take this opportunity to welcome…	Given the research and developmental trends in the area/field, it was found to be important to…	This gathering presents…
I welcome you all to…	We need to give attention to…	The occasion offers a unique platform for…
I extend a warm welcome to	The situation implores us to focus on…	This event showcases a window of opportunity to…

A few useful phrases for proposing the vote of thanks are given below.

I have the task of delivering the vote of thanks to this august gathering here.

My thanks to distinguished….

I am also grateful to…

I must also thank the other members of…

My thanks to all…

It's a great honour to have this opportunity to thank all of you.

We are deeply indebted to…

We would like to thank…

We are very grateful to you for…

In this connection, we would like to make particular mention of…

We thank you for your patience…

Thank you so much.

Presentation of a speech:

A speech must have a clear and realistic purpose. The purpose can be: to instruct, to persuade or to entertain. The content is often rather general and factual. When the speech is over, the audience should have added something more to their knowledge.

Instruct

In an instructional speech, the aim is to teach the audience knowledge and skills. After the presentation, the listener should have learnt a skill.

Persuade

A persuasive speech should aim to stimulate people to do something. After the presentation, the listener should have been inspired or motivated to do something innovative and creative.

Entertain

The aim of this type of speech is mostly to make the audience feel happy, but there may be hidden goals. For example, to reveal important truths or move ideas forward. A crucial element in this type is to add some humour. For most people it is very difficult to give a humorous presentation because the humour is not spontaneous.

Unit-6_130-158_SPC_Appendix - March-11-2018.indd 132 21-01-2019 10:41:17